Interviews

Interviewee	Active user	Issues they mentioned
Interviewee A	Active 937-day streak	Battery drains fast, **content generalization**, AI grammar and dialect mismatch, few languages, buggy widgets, streak breaks from travel, single-answer chess
Interviewee B	Active 1,007-day streak	Streak-only motivation, **content generalization**, too theoretical, AI grammar errors, busy UI, annoying reminders, ads after lessons, no free conversation practice
Interviewee C	Active 1,264-day streak	Energy drains on correct answers, premium not worth it, uses app less
Interviewee D	Not active (Boo!)	Finished his Spanish class, no longer needs it
Interviewee E	On and off	Lost interest in streak, can't hold a conversation in real life, **content generalization**

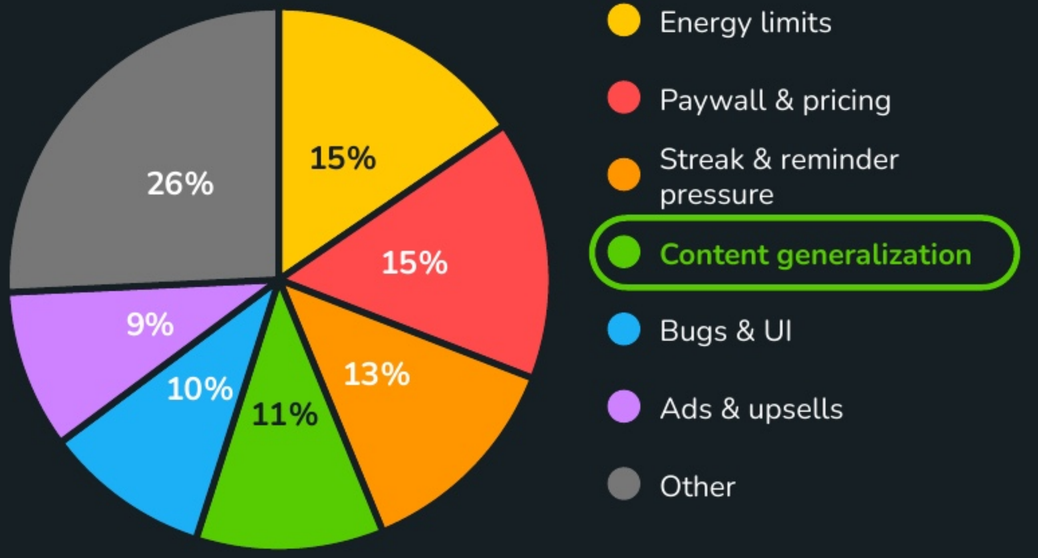
Problem I chose: Content generalization

Why: An issue that I personally have. 3 of 5 interviewees raised it, and it shows up in the reviews.

The Problem



Reviews



500 most recent US App Store reviews, as of Oct 16. Main issue per review shown for the 233 (47%) that mention one; 267 had no complaint.

The KPI + Big Idea



THE BIG IDEA

Your goal picks the situations you learn.

Today everyone starts on the same path of cafés and greetings. With a goal path, a learner gets lessons specific to their goals with language learning.

TODAY
Order a coffee

→

GOAL: TRAVEL
Ask for directions

THE KPI

DAU

58.7M daily learners in Q2 2026, up 23% year over year

Driver metric: lessons per DAU

Our two 1,000+ day streakers open the app mainly to keep the streak. One said why: the lessons aren't usable in real life.

THE ROI

+1% DAU ≈ +587K daily learners

Lessons that fit real life turn a streak check-in into a full session. General lessons stay, so nothing is lost.

The Feature: Core Experience



Existing feature

How much Latin do you know?

- I'm new to Latin
- I know some common words
- I can have basic conversations
- I can talk about various topics
- I can discuss most topics in detail

CONTINUE

New feature

What are your goals for learning Latin?

- **General** — Learn for personal interest
- **Travel** — Use Latin while traveling
- **Media consumption** — Understand movies, books, and more
- **Work (career boost)** — Advance my career or professional goals
- **Family (heritage and relationships)** — Connect with my heritage and loved ones

CONTINUE

Existing feature

Where would you like to start?

RECOMMENDED

- **Start from scratch** — Take the easiest lesson of the Latin course
- **Find my level** — Let Duo recommend where you should start learning

CONTINUE

Existing feature

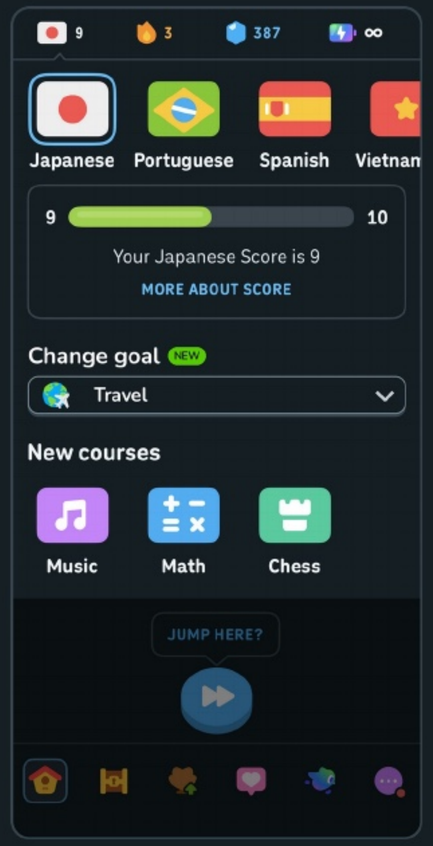
Okay! Get ready for Unit 1 Lesson 1.

CONTINUE

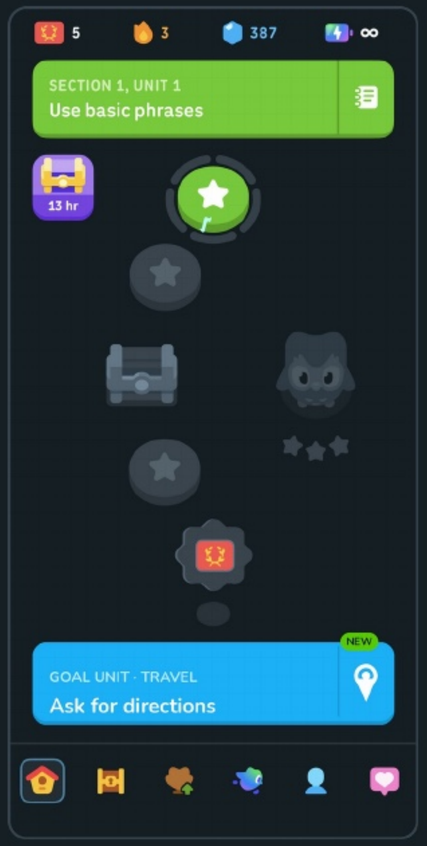
The Product Specification



1 Tap the language icon



2 Goal Units on the path



WHERE IT LIVES

- New learners: the goal question at course start
- Existing learners: tap the language icon, then Change goal above New courses
- Goal Units show on the path with a Goal tag

HOW IT WORKS

- Pick a goal: General, Travel, Media, Work or Family
- About 1 in 3 units is a Goal Unit (placeholder ratio) built around your goal
- General lessons stay: the ones every goal shares, like greetings and goodbyes

CONFLICTS SOLVED

- “Find my level” still runs first, then the goal layers on top
- Energy, XP and streak work like any other lesson
- Changing goals keeps all progress

EDGE CASES

- General or no goal: default path
- No goal content for the course: default path
- Wants grammar basics: general lessons still teach them
- Cap goal changes (1 per week)

Validation + A/B Test



BEFORE WE BUILD ANYTHING

The big bet: Learners do more lessons when the scenarios match why they're learning.

Test 1, talk to 60 learners. 20 daily users, 20 on-and-off users and 20 who quit each try a clickable Goal Path mockup and pick a Goal Unit or a normal unit.

Test 2, check the app itself. Start the same course twice, once as “travel” and once as “career”, and compare the first 3 units. If Duolingo already changes them, we narrow the idea.

Pass: About two thirds (40 of 60) pick the Goal Unit and find it more useful, and some who quit say they'd come back.

Stop: Fewer than 20 of 60 prefer it, or Duolingo already tailors the first units.

Timeline: Weeks 1–2 test with the 60, weeks 3–8 build 3 Goal Units, weeks 9–12 run the A/B test.

THE A/B TEST

What we build	One course, Travel goal only, 3 Goal Units from exercise types Duolingo already has
Who sees it	5% of new learners in one country, for 4 weeks. Half get today's path, half get Goal Path.
What we watch	Mainly how many lessons each daily learner does, and whether they're still around a month later
Also checking	Do people start and finish Goal Units, switch their goal, and come back after a week?
Must hold steady	Finishing general lessons, Super upgrades, app crashes
What we track	goal_selected, goal_changed, goal_unit_started, goal_unit_completed, goal_unit_skipped
How we decide	Ship it if learners do more lessons and nothing above gets worse. Tweak it if they finish Goal Units but do no more lessons. Drop it if most skip them.